



There aren't that many clients supporting UNII-4. But should your entire home ecosystem be compatible with UNII-4, then you can enjoy really high speeds with minimal interference, a dream in dense urban environments.

The RT6600ax runs on Synology's proprietary operating system, Synology Router Manager (SRM). SRM offers an intuitive and user-friendly interface that makes it easy to manage and customise the router's settings. Features such as parental controls, Quality of Service (QoS), and traffic monitoring are all easily accessible and configurable. Security is a top priority for Synology, and the RT6600ax is equipped with a range of features to protect your network. The router also supports VLAN (Virtual Local Area Network) segmentation, allowing you to create separate networks for different devices, which can help to isolate and protect sensitive data. This is another premium feature that's difficult to find in budget products.

For those who require secure remote access, the RT6600ax offers VPN support like many routers in its price tier. It supports multiple VPN protocols, including OpenVPN, PPTP, and L2TP/IPsec, ensuring compatibility with a wide range of devices and services. The router's powerful CPU ensures that VPN connections are fast and reliable, even when multiple users are connected.

The inclusion of a USB 3.2 Gen 1 port adds to the RT6600ax's versatility. This port can be used to connect external

storage devices, allowing you to share files across your network or create a simple NAS setup. The USB port can also be used to connect a printer, making it accessible to all devices on your network.

PERFORMANCE

The true test of any router lies in its performance, and the Synology RT6600ax does not disappoint. We tested the router in various scenarios to evaluate its uplink and downlink speeds across all bands. On the 2.4GHz band, the RT6600ax delivered impressive



speeds. In close proximity to the router, we achieved download speeds of up to 304 Mbps and upload speeds of around 151 Mbps. These speeds are more than sufficient for everyday tasks such as browsing, streaming music, and video calls. Even when kept at a distance, with walls in between, the speeds remained respectable, with downloads at around 155 Mbps and uploads at 82 Mbps.

The 5GHz band offered significantly higher speeds, as expected. In close range, download speeds reached up to 1454 Mbps, with upload speeds of 911

Mbps. This band is ideal for high-bandwidth activities such as 4K streaming and online gaming. At a distance of 30 feet, the speeds were still impressive, with downloads at 1202 Mbps and uploads at 645 Mbps.

We could not test the 5.9 GHz band since we don't have any UNII-4 clients at the moment with us.

Using the 2.5GbE WAN/LAN port, we tested wired connections to see how the router handled gigabit and multi-gigabit connections. The performance was stellar, with consistent speeds of 2.5Gbps in both directions. This makes the RT6600ax an excellent choice for users with high-speed internet connections and those who require stable and fast wired connections for gaming or large file transfers.

VERDICT

The Synology RT6600ax is a powerful and versatile router that excels in both performance and features. Its build quality is top-notch, with a robust external body and high-quality internal components that ensure long-term reliability. The range of features, including Wi-Fi 6 support, advanced security options, and extensive VPN capabilities, make it a great choice for both advanced users and those looking for a simple, reliable router. What really takes the cake is the Synology Router Management software which is one of the best that we have seen so far. Performance-wise, the RT6600ax delivers impressive speeds across all bands and as a result, this is a standout router that offers excellent value for money for enthusiasts. For the average joe, this is one expensive router at ₹37,700.

—Mithun Mohandas

SPECIFICATIONS

Model: RT6600ax | Wi-Fi: 802.11ax | LAN: 3x 1 GbE, 1x 2.5 GbE | WAN: 1x GbE / 2.5 GbE Dual WAN | SoC: IPQ6018 | WLAN: QCN9024 | Dimensions: 17.5 x 32 x 20 cms | Weight: 1.6 kg | Warranty: 2 years.

CONTACT

Synology | Phone - NA | Email - Online form | Website - www.synology.com